Students Studying in Canada

APPLYING FOR A STUDY PERMIT

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WHAT IS A STUDY PERMIT?

A Study Permit is the immigration document issued by Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) that provides permission for an international student to study in Canada. This permit is your status document while you are studying in Canada and you must make sure to meet the requirements of your study permit. See here (https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-

- citizenship/corporate/publications-manuals/operational-bulletins-manuals/temporary-residents/study-permits/assessing-conditions.html) for more information about the conditions under a study permit.

It is your responsibility to ensure that your Study Permit is valid for the duration of your academic program in Canada.

If you are from a country that requires an entry visa (TRV) OR an eTA, this will be issued for you upon approval of your study permit – you do not make a separate application for a travel visa. On approval, you will be given a visa or eTA and a letter of introduction to travel to Canada and you will be issued your study permit upon arriving at the Port of Entry in Canada.

When to Apply

The Study Permit application process can be lengthy. It is very important you apply for the permit as soon as you receive the Provincial Attestation Letter and Proof of Acceptance letter. We recommend applying a minimum of 3-4 months before your program start date. Be sure to check with IRCC to determine the estimated processing time based on your country of application.

Provincial Attestation Letter (PAL) and Proof of Acceptance (POA) Letter

You will need your PAL and a POA (also called Letter of Acceptance) to submit with your Study Permit application. The PAL and POA will be available to download on your application portal, once you are eligible for a PAL and you have paid the required deposit by the deadline.

Please note that OGS Canada does not issue PALs or POAs. These documents are generated automatically in your portal once you are eligible.

Payments

For payment information, please see the Student Financial Services webpage on Billing (https://sac.northeastern.edu/billing/).

APPLY FOR YOUR STUDY PERMIT

Students may apply for their Study Permit (https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/study-canada.html) via an online application portal or via paper application. You also have the option of using the services of an authorized third party application collection service, called a Visa Application Centre (VAC) (https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/corporate/contact-ircc/offices/find-visa-application-centre.html). If you are able, apply using the online application portal, as generally, online applications are processed more quickly than paper applications. Estimated processing times per country are available on the IRCC site.

All the information you need for the Study Permit application process is available on the IRCC website. This process is not managed by Northeastern University and we do not have additional insight into processing times or delays.

If you choose to use the services of an immigration advisor or lawyer to assist you with your application, please be certain to choose someone who is legally permitted to represent you to IRCC. To determine if a person is an authorized representative, please read the guidelines here (https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigration-citizenship-representative/choose/authorized.html). Additionally, check the CICC webpage on top tips to prevent immigration fraud (https://college-ic.ca/protecting-the-public/fraud-prevention/top-tips).

Documents Required for Initial Study Permit

Please visit the official IRCC website (https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/study-canada/study-permit/get-documents.html) for the complete details.

Please make sure to also read the visa office specific guidelines for your country of nationality.

Provincial Attestation Letter

Starting in 2024, the Government of Canada introduced the Provincial Attestation Letter (PAL), a new requirement for international students applying for a study permit to begin studies in Canada. For more details, visit the Government of Canada website (https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/study-canada/study-permit/get-documents/provincial-attestation-letter.html). All international students applying for a program at a Northeastern University Canadian campus will need to have a PAL from Northeastern to apply for their study permit.

You can find detailed information here (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/student-support/global-campuses/canada/poa-and-deposit-process/).

Proof of Acceptance (POA) Letter

Also called a Letter of Acceptance, you will receive this document with details about your program after you are deemed PAL eligible, pay the PAL deposit, and receive your PAL. You must upload this document as your letter of acceptance, please do not use your admission decision letter.

FYI: Program End Date/Completion Date

You will need to use the estimated amount of time shown on your POA in the Length of Program section to provide an estimate of your Completion Date. For example, if your POA states:

Completion Date: N/K
Or minimum 20 months of full-time studies

Then your Completion Date should be estimated as 20 months after your Program Start Date. **We cannot provide students with a specific date**, as the length of time varies with every student depending on co-op opportunities, leaves of absence, course schedules etc. You will be able to apply for Study Permit Extension if you ended up needing more time to complete the program.

STUDY PERMIT APPLICATION SUPPORT

To support your study permit application, the Office of Global Services (OGS) invites admitted international students at our Canadian campuses to attend a required three-part webinar series. You must attend one session from each of the three topics in the series to be fully prepared. OGS Canada strongly advises that you do not submit your study permit application until you have completed a Study Permit Information Session led by one of our certified Canadian immigration consultants on the advising team:

- **Study Permit Application Series I, Strategies and Best Practices**
- **Study Permit Application Series II, Proof of Funds Preparation**
    - Budget Sheet Planning Sample (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/wp-content/uploads/sites/2/2026/04/Budget-Sheet-Sample-1.pdf)

- **Study Permit Application Series III, Crafting Your Study Plan**
    - Study Plan Handout (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs-ca/wp-content/uploads/sites/6/2026/07/Study-Plan-Handout.pdf)

To register for the sessions, please visit the OGS Canada Information Sessions webpage (https://connect.northeastern.edu/portal/ogs_canada_info_session).

AFTER APPLYING FOR A STUDY PERMIT

Update OGS Canada about the status of your study permit application. This is a two step process:

1. Complete Step 1: Study Permit Application Status e-form (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/forms-and-guides/canadian-study-permit-application-status-update/) to let us know when you applied for your study permit

2. After you receive a decision on your study permit application, complete Step 2: Study Permit Application Outcome e-form (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/forms-and-guides/canadian-study-permit-application-outcome-step-2/) to submit either:

- Proof of study permit **approval**: Letter of Introduction, Study Permit Extension Confirmation, Study Permit
- Proof of study permit **refusal**: refusal correspondence letter and officer decision notes
- Proof that your was application withdrawn

If you are approved for a study permit to study at a Northeastern Canadian campus, all further communications such as Pre-Arrival Orientation, travelling to Canada, and purchasing mandatory health insurance (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/student-support/global-campuses/canada/health-insurance/) will come to your Northeastern student email. Ensure that you set up your Northeastern account and you are checking your student emails regularly.

STUDENT WORK PLACEMENT

Changes to co-op work permit requirements for post-secondary international students

As of April 1, 2026, international students don't need a co-op work permit for student work placements, such as co-ops or internships, as a post-secondary student studying at Northeastern University Canadian campuses.

International students admitted to a Northeastern University Canadian campus will no longer need to apply for a separate co-op work permit when they apply for their initial study permit, as per guidelines provided by IRCC. For detailed

information, please visit IRCC website: Work in a student work placement (https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/study-canada/work/intern.html).

NEXT STEPS

If your application is approved, the visa office serving your country of residence/citizenship will issue you a Letter of Introduction. Please read through your Letter of Introduction/Port of Entry letter (POE) closely and carefully. Further instructions related to requirements for a Temporary Resident Visa (TRV), Entry Visa, or eTA will be included in this letter. Please note that it is imperative that you take any next steps outlined in your Letter of Introduction (POE) in a timely manner. **Do not book your travel arrangements to Canada until you've received your Letter of Introduction.**

Update OGS Canada on the result of your study permit application to ensure you receive timely and necessary communications. Follow these instructions (https://northeastern.service-now.com/kb_view.do?sysparm_article=KB000022168) carefully.

If you have further questions about next steps after a study permit approval, please reach out to OGS Canada using this inquiry form (https://service.northeastern.edu/ogs?id=ogs_ask_a_question&sys_id=47cb95e387e1759011b72fc5dabb3512).

CONTACT OGS

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